

U.S. History





About the Course

Read about U.S. history from 1800-1900 through books that immerse students in the time period and allow them to see the world through the eyes of those who lived it. Through engaging narratives, history spines, primary source documents, and books that show different perspectives, students come to see history as more than dates and events and develop relationships with people from the past. Viewing images, looking at maps, and working on one's Book of Centuries are also part of developing this relationship.

This topic is included in the following course(s): History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)



Placement & Combining Tips

U.S. history may be suitable for 9th graders as well if combining.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7-8	U.S. History: Grades 7-8 2 times/week 30 min	A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860 Abraham Lincoln and Frederick Douglass: The Story Behind and American Friendship A Year in the South: 1865 Sacajawea Gold Mountain

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)				
	World History: Grades 7-8 U.S. History: Grades 7-8		Ancient History: Grades 7-9 U.S. History: Grades 7-8	



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

U.S. History: Grades 7-8



A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860



Abraham Lincoln and Frederick Douglass: The Story Behind and American Friendship



A Year in the South: 1865



Sacajawea



Gold Mountain



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)
(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)
- ∞ [History Charts & Timelines Scope & Sample](#)
- ∞ [Century Chart](#)
- ∞ [Grade 7 U.S. History Chart Prompts](#)
- ∞ [Grade 8 U.S. History Chart Prompts](#)
- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 15: History.\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



U.S. History: Grades 7-8

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any necessary links.
- If you have not read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance.
- Decide which lessons/books to read together and which to have students read independently.



Recap

- Connect back to the previous lesson. Have students give a summary of what they remember. (Full narration is not necessary.)
- If the previous passage is difficult to remember, teachers may ask a leading question: "What can you tell me about..." Or students may try looking back at any chapter/section headings or illustrations or reading the first paragraph to jog the memory.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson (often included in lesson plans).
- If necessary, talk about a few unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage out loud or have the student read independently. Sometimes reading for the specified time is a better guide.
- If a book is challenging, try stopping to narrate every now and then rather than waiting until the end. It can also help to read aloud. Or you might want to use an audiobook version of the text and have students read along with it.
- Have students keep an eye out for events or characters to add to their Citizenship Notebook, Book of Centuries, or Copywork Book.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally or write a narration.
- Alternatively, students might analyze a character, trace cause to consequence, outline a passage, or use one of the other methods indicated by Charlotte Mason in School Education Chapter 16, especially p.180.
- Students who enjoy writing can experiment with different types of written narrations, but this is not required.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made (orally or in writing).

- You could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question to stimulate discussion. Discussion questions are often included in the lesson plans.



Connect

- Optional: Add something to the Book of Centuries, Century Chart, Citizenship Notebook, or Commonplace book. If students would like to include pictures, these may be drawn or printed.

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 1

The War of 1812

Materials: PDF Link

→ INTRO

1. This year you are studying the time period 1800-1900. The books we are reading begin in 1820. Today's lesson will highlight some significant events that happened before 1820, and we will begin the book next week. The American Revolution ended in 1783 with the signing of the Treaty of Paris, where the U.S. was acknowledged as a sovereign nation. In 1800, the U.S. population totaled 5.3 million, including one million African Americans, of whom 900,000 were enslaved.

2. Imagine what life was like in the U.S. in the early 1800's. Describe what you know about transportation, communication, food production, and clothing. Many important inventions were created during this time, and people's way of life changed due to the Industrial Revolution. Watch this video to learn more about this.

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Industrial Revolution (8:00)

• What inventions do you think were the most impactful for people at that time? What are some of the inventions you are most grateful for?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

This is a chapter from Joy Hakim's book *A History of US*, Volume 4.

∞ PDF Link: The War of 1812

• IMPORTANT DATES

War of 1812 between America and Britain

WEEK 1 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 2

The Beginning of the Story

Materials: Sacajawea

→ INTRO

By the age of 16, Sacajawea had been kidnapped from her tribe, gambled away to be a man's second wife, and was pregnant with that man's baby. That's when she would join the journey of Meriwether Lewis and William Clark down the Mississippi River and to the Pacific Ocean. But, where did her story begin?

Joseph Bruchac will explore the early life of Sacajawea as well as recount her journey with Lewis and Clark, which became one of the most famous expeditions to take place in American History. While it is well researched and Joseph Bruchac uses primary sources like the journals of Lewis and Clark as support for the story, it remains a work of fiction. There is much that we don't know about Sacajawea's story.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Begin with the "Author's Note" p.195-199.

Read the Prologue and Ch.1.

• How different would Sacajawea's life have been if she had stayed amongst her people?

• IMPORTANT DATES

Thomas Jefferson is voted in as the 3rd president of the United States in 1800

• TERMINOLOGY

The Minnatree tribe was also known as the Hidatsa tribe. Hidatsa is the more common name.

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 2 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 3

Antebellum, The Long Way West

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ INTRO

Where can we find the words "We hold these truths to be self-evident, that all men are created equal, that they are endowed by their Creator with certain unalienable Rights, that among these are Life, Liberty and the pursuit of Happiness"? (Declaration of Independence) What would you say is happiness? What did people in the 1800's think it was? For many people, it meant owning land. This year, you will read extensively about people exploring new lands, migrating to new places, and the formation of new states.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Poem on p.5
2. Preface & Ch.1 p.9-15 (Read the narrative and then go back and read captions and sidebars.)

- How did Long describe his findings from the edge of the plains of the Mississippi woodlands to the Rocky Mountains?

• DEFINITIONS

yeoman farmer (p.10): a person who owns and cultivates a small farm

cash crop (p.10): a readily salable crop (such as cotton or tobacco) produced or gathered primarily for market

WEEK 2 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 4

The Corps of Discovery, Among the Minnetarees

Materials: Sacajawea

→ INTRO

In the election of 1800, Thomas Jefferson was announced as the third president of the United States. Arguably, one of his greatest actions as president came to be known as the Louisiana Purchase. Around the summer of 1803, after the Louisiana Purchase, Thomas Jefferson would choose a group of people, including William Clark and Meriwether Lewis, to explore the newly acquired land. They would be called the Corps of Discovery.

→ VIEW

∞ Link: Louisiana Purchase, 1803

Read through the page and view the map for more information about the Louisiana Purchase.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2-3 p.8-23 "Where was I" - "up the river."

- How did Sacajawea describe her time with the Minnetaree people?

• IMPORTANT DATES

Thomas Jefferson completes the Louisiana Purchase in 1803
Thomas Jefferson sends Lewis and Clark on the expedition in 1804

• DEFINITIONS

ensign (p.9): a junior officer in the military

WEEK 3 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 5

Mountain Men, Riding the Trail to Santa Fe

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2-3 p.16-25

- Why was the discovery of the South Pass so important?

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 3 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 6

York, Stories up the River, and Looking for Indians

Materials: Sacajawea

→ INTRO

One of the men who aided in the expedition was a man named York, who had grown up enslaved by the Clark family. He would be helpful on the expedition, but Lewis and Clark also knew that they needed someone who knew the lands they were sent to explore. These lands had been places no white man had ever entered before.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.23-33 "Bad as the" - "a Supr. quality."

- What were some struggles that the expedition encountered early on?

★ STUDENT/TEACHER NOTE

Quallity is intentionally misspelled as this is how it's written in the journal.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Due to some of the content, skip p.20-22.

WEEK 4 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 7

Trail of Tears

Materials: PDF link

→ INTRO

The settlers wanted more land. The Native American Tribes inhabited this land. So between 1816 and 1840, Tribes, including Cherokees, Chickasaws, Creeks, Seminoles, and Choctaws, signed treaties that gave up their land to the US. Around 1829, Andrew Jackson and Congress passed an act called the Indian Removal Act that forced remaining tribes to move west. There were over 100,000 Native Americans who were forced from their homes to make a journey that many of them would not survive.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

PDF Link: Trail of Tears (from Hakim's History of US Vol. 4)

• IMPORTANT DATES

James Madison elected as president and serves from 1809-1817

• EXTRA HELPING

This video takes you through a part of the Trail of Tears as it looks now.

∞ Video Link: Trail of Tears video

WEEK 4 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 8

Looking for Indians, Little Mice

Materials: Sacajawea

→ INTRO

The news about the expedition had spread, and tribes awaited the vessel that was rumored to be "a boat with many guns." Lewis and Clark's expedition also served another purpose. They were to act as messengers to the tribes that they had a new leader: the President of the United States.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.33-44 "those plains were" - "we will follow."

- How are Lewis and Clark greeted by the various tribes they encounter?
- How does Sacajawea remember the arrival of the Clark expedition?

WEEK 5 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 9

Susan Magoffin's Diary, Pioneers: Taking the Trail West

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

• IMPORTANT DATES

James Monroe elected as president and serves from 1817-1825

Missouri Compromise 1820

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
Ch.4-5 p.26-37

WEEK 5 **30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 10**
Making Peace, the White Men's Fort

Materials: Sacajawea

→ **INTRO**

One of the biggest dangers when encountering explorers was what they brought with them. Smallpox was one such danger and Native Americans and their remedies were no match for the virus. For those who survived the virus, it left them scarred. Though there had been some remedies that showed improvement, the reality was that Native American tribes were ill-prepared to face such a virus.

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
Ch.8-9 p.45-59

- How does Sacajawea describe the fort?

WEEK 6 **30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 11**
Getting There, Latter-Day Saints

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ **RECAP**

Think about where you've left off.

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
Ch.6-7 p.38-47

- What would it have been like to travel in a wagon train?

• **STUDENT TIP**

Be sure to add some people, events, and drawings of artifacts to your book of centuries.

• **IMPORTANT DATES**

John Quincy Adams elected as president and serves from 1825-1829
Indian Removal Act of 1830
Martin Van Buren elected as president and serves from 1837-1841

WEEK 6 **30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 12**
Charbonneau's Demands, Departures

Materials: Sacajawea

→ **NOTE**

We are skipping Ch.10 for the sake of time.

→ **RECAP**

Think about where you've left off.

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
Ch.11-12 p.63-73

- What benefits did one receive for being on the expedition with Lewis and Clark?

WEEK 7 **30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 13**
Coast-to-Coast Destiny, Texas: Tempting and Beautiful

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ **NOTE**

We are skipping Ch.9 since we are reading about Frémont in geography.

→ **RECAP**

Think about where you've left off.

• **IMPORTANT DATES**

James K. Polk elected as president and serves from 1845-1849
Gold Rush of 1849 in California
Compromise of 1850

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
Ch.8 & 10 p.48-53, 58-63

WEEK 7 **30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 14**
The Great Falls, Flash Flood, The Three Forks

Materials: Sacajawea

→ **NOTE**
We are skipping Ch.13-15 for the sake of time.

→ **INTRO**
Sacajawea found herself able to help the expedition in more ways than just translating for her people. Growing up in the village, she knew that there would come a time when it would be impossible to hunt and that the survival of people depended on finding food in other ways. Mainly, she taught them how to forage for edible roots.

There would be more difficulties than just running low on food. One of the largest would be grizzly bears. Even though Lewis and Clark were outfitted with guns and bullets, they had a hard time taking down the grizzlies, which caused Captain Lewis to say, "these bears being so hard to die rather intimidates me." A canoe nearly sank, animals charged their tents, and Sacajawea came down with an illness.

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
Ch.16-18 p.90-104

- How does Sacajawea help guide Lewis and Clark? What does she contribute to the company of explorers?

WEEK 8 **30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 15**
Fighting Over a Border, There's Gold In Them Hills

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ **RECAP**
Think about where you've left off.

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
Ch.11-12 p.64-77

- What is something that shocked you in this reading?

WEEK 8 **30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 16**
What do you Call Us, Finding the Shoshones, Reunion

Materials: Sacajawea

→ **RECAP**
Think about where you've left off.

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
Ch.19-21 p.105-124

- Why were the Shoshones hesitant to follow Captain Lewis?

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 9 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 17

Clipper Ships and Pony Express, Flying By Stagecoach

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.13-14 p.78-89

- How did Clipper Ships and the Pony Express impact the United States?

• IMPORTANT DATES

William Henry Harrison elected as president and serves in 1841

William Henry Harrison gets sick and dies after only just 31 days in office

WEEK 9 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 18

The Welcome, New Names, The Terrible Trail, Quamash

Materials: Sacajawea

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.22-25 p.125-141

- How does Sacajawea react to finding her tribe? Her family?

WEEK 10 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 19

Arithmetic at Sea, Thar She Blows

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ INTRO

Whaling is just one of the many industries that became more and more popular in the 1800s.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.15-16 p.90-101

- Does anything surprise you in this week's reading?

• IMPORTANT DATES

John Tyler becomes president and serves from 1841-1845

WEEK 10 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 20

Many Rapids, Many Nations, The Great Hungry Water, At Fort Clatsop, Thieves, Doctoring the Nez Percé

Materials: Sacajawea

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.26-30 p.142-167

- Why was writing so important to Lewis and Clark?

WEEK 11 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 21

A Japanese Boy in America, Cities and Progress

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1	
→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.17-18 p.102-111	
WEEK 11 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 22 <i>Deep Snow, Five Fingers Parted, The Journey's End, Old Friends No Longer with Us, The Final Word</i> Materials: Sacajawea → RECAP Think about where you've left off. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.31-35 p.167-194	
WEEK 12 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 23 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Sacajawea	
WEEK 12 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 24 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860	

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 25

A Land of Movers, Workin' on the Railroad

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.19-20 p.112-119

- How would the railroad affect people differently?

• STUDENT TIP

Be sure to add some people, events, and drawings of artifacts to your book of centuries.

WEEK 1 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 26

Waiting for Mr. Lincoln, Born into Slavery

Materials: Abraham Lincoln and Frederick Douglass: The Story Behind an American Friendship

→ INTRO

This book begins in 1863, two years after the Civil War started. Abraham Lincoln was the President and never thought the war would last this long. He was trying to hold the country together as best he could. Frederick Douglass, who was a formerly enslaved man, became one of the strongest voices against slavery. Although Lincoln and Douglass initially disagreed about various matters, their discussions were profitable and instrumental to the cause of freedom.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1-2 p.1-17

- What does the rule against teaching a slave to read tell you about the importance of books?
- How did learning to read influence the decisions of Frederick?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview the sentence on p.12 where Frederick talks about taking his life.

• DEFINITIONS

calling card: also known as a visiting card, a small, decorative card that was carried by individuals to present themselves to others (p.2)

WEEK 2 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 27

She Wishes to Ornament Their Minds, Do Girls Have Brains

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.21-22 p.120-129

- How did people view women in the 1800s? How did that change through the years?

WEEK 2 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 28

Soul on Fire, Nothing but Plenty of Friends

Materials: Abraham Lincoln and Frederick Douglass: The Story Behind an American Friendship

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3-4 p.19-41

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

- What do you find interesting about Douglass' journey from a slave to a famous writer and lecturer?
- How did Lincoln become a self-made man?

WEEK 3 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 29

Seneca Falls and the Rights of Women, A Woman Named Truth, Life in the Mills

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.23-25 p.130-141

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Why Sojourner Truth Changed Her Name
Watch the video to learn more about Sojourner Truth.

- What did you learn about Sojourner in the reading or the video?

WEEK 3 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 30

A House Divided, Debating the Future of Slavery in America

Materials: Abraham Lincoln and Frederick Douglass: The Story Behind an American Friendship

→ RECAP

Briefly summarize what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5-6 p.43-63

- What do you think about Lincoln's view of slavery at this point? Do you disagree with any aspects of it?

WEEK 4 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 31

Working Women and Children, American Writers

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.26-27 p.142-149

- How familiar are you with the writers of the 1800s? Have you read or interacted with any of the books mentioned in this section?

WEEK 4 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 32

Emancipation, Mr. Douglass

Materials: Abraham Lincoln and Frederick Douglass: The Story Behind an American Friendship

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7-8 p.65-85

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

- Why didn't Lincoln initially think he had the authority to free the slaves?
- What does it say about President Lincoln that even though Frederick couldn't agree with him, he could "respect his humane spirit"?

WEEK 5 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 33

Mr. Thoreau, Melville and Company

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.28-29 p.150-155

- Thoreau wrote, "In Wildness is the preservation of the World." Do you agree?

WEEK 5 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 34

Lincoln's Secret Plan, My Friend Douglass

Materials: Abraham Lincoln and Frederick Douglass: The Story Behind an American Friendship

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9-10 p.87-103

- How would you describe the friendship of Lincoln and Douglass?

WEEK 6 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 35

If a Poet Writes You a Letter, Pay Attention, Amistad means Friendship

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ NOTE

We are skipping Ch.31 because we are reading about John James Audubon in geography.

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.30 & 32 p.156-161, 171-176

WEEK 6 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 36

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ INTRO

This historical novel is based on the building of the transcontinental railroad, which took place from 1863-1869. It was an arduous, dangerous job for the men who signed up to do it. Historians estimate that at any one time as many as 10,000 to 15,000 Chinese were working on constructing the railroad. It took more than four years to complete the western section of the railroad and connect the coasts. This story will bring this time period to life and give you a glimpse of what those workers endured so they could send money back to their families in China. Upon completion of the railroad, some workers went back to China; others stayed in America to work in agriculture, mining, logging, or domestic service or work in



Term 2

manufacturing to produce cigars and other items.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Read author's note p.274-276
2. p.1-12 beginning - "to say or do."

- What customs or traditions in Chinese culture have you noticed so far?"

→ BACKGROUND

1. Foot binding — the practice of applying tight binding to the feet of young girls to prevent further growth — was a Chinese custom historically associated with the wealthy. Small feet were considered more attractive and, therefore, necessary to find a more suitable partner. It was banned in 1911, but the practice continued in rural areas until circa 1949, when women were forced to remove the bindings on their "lotus feet" by governmental decree.
2. Read the top sections of this article to learn about the Taiping Rebellion, which Ling Fan's dad was accused of being a part of.
∞ Article Link: Taiping Rebellion

WEEK 7 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 37

Webster Defends the Union, Fleeing to Freedom

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ NOTE

We are skipping Ch.34-35 because those topics are covered in the Lincoln & Douglass book.

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ INTRO

In the novel *Master Slave Husband Wife*, Ilyon Woo wrote the story of William and Ellen Craft. She wrote, "In 1848 William and Ellen Craft, an enslaved couple in Georgia, embarked upon a five-thousand-mile journey of mutual self-emancipation across the world. Theirs is a love story that begins in a time of revolution—a revolution unfinished in the American War for Independence, a revolution that endures." As you read through their story (Ch.36), take note of all the different things that they needed to do in order to escape into freedom.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.33 & 36 p.177-179, 188-190

WEEK 7 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 38

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

What is going on so far in the story?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.13-26 "Ling Fan shook" - "hot as a cinder."

- What do you notice about the way marriage is approached in that culture?

→ BACKGROUND

Qingming is a festival for honoring ancestors that is celebrated on the 15th day after the spring equinox, generally falling in early April. The main activity is the cleaning or sweeping of ancestral tombs, and thus it is

★ TEACHER NOTE

There is a reference to a woman's cycle on p.25.

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

sometimes referred to as "Tomb Sweeping Day." The festival is an ancient one, dating back at least 2,500 years in Chinese history. (mentioned on p.23 of book)

WEEK 8 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 39

Over the River and Underground, Seven Decades

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.37-38 p.191-198

- What was most shocking in these chapters?

• IMPORTANT DATES

Zachery Taylor elected as president and serves from 1849-1850

Millard Fillmore elected as president and serves from 1850-1853

Franklin Pierce elected as president and serves from 1853-1857

James Buchanan elected as president and serves from 1857-1861

WEEK 8 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 40

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Map of China

1. Locate the Pearl River. The ship went down this river to the village where Ling Fan lived.
2. Find Guangzhou. This is the busy seaport where men board a bigger ship bound for America.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.26-40 "That night" - "she stepped forward."

→ BACKGROUND

Why did the Chinese call America "Gold Mountain"?

In the 1840s, the news circled the globe: There was gold in California, and fortunes could be made by anyone who seized the opportunity. Within weeks, dreamers from far and wide came streaming into America's port cities, hoping to stake a claim and strike it rich. China was not immune to this new gold fever. Word of a mountain of gold across the ocean arrived in Hong Kong in 1849, and quickly spread throughout the Chinese provinces. By 1851, 25,000 Chinese immigrants had left their homes and moved to California, a land some came to call *gam saan*, or "gold mountain." (from History of Congress website)

WEEK 9 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 41

Materials: Book of Centuries, Story of US (Optional)

→ NOTEBOOK

Take this time to work on your Book of Centuries. Include dates for U.S., World, Ancient, and Church history. Dates are in the various lessons under "Important Dates" or on p.199 of The Story of US. Don't forget to draw items as well that represent the 19th century. There are examples in the back of the Our Work books.



Term 2

WEEK 9 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 42

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Skip the beginning of the chapter (p.41-47) for the sake of time and some crass descriptions.
2. p.47-61 "Sometime in the middle"- "the new country."

- Do you think Ling Fan's plan will work, or will she be found out?

→ VIEW

Throughout the lessons, you will be watching segments from a webinar that was hosted by the Chinese Railroad Workers in North America Project at Stanford University. Some people might think that history is about dates and events and that there is nothing new to find out about the past. But when we look at primary sources, there might be "new stories" to uncover that are not part of the usual narrative. That is what historians do. They study primary sources to answer questions about the past. Primary sources are forms of evidence that come directly from the period or persons or events we are seeking to understand. These can be journals, letters, photos, newspapers, and other writings. That is what this project is about. We don't know a lot about the Chinese railroad workers who came to America in the late 1800s to find jobs and build America. These historians are trying to bring these stories to us.

This segment talks about the project and the kinds of primary sources they studied.

∞ Video Link: Stanford University Research (7:30-11:30)

WEEK 10 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 43

Architecture

Materials: Notebook

→ NOTE

For the next two weeks, you will be learning about different styles of homes that were common in America in the 1800s.

→ INTRO

Do you see any buildings or homes in your area that have columns? Around 1820, a movement of Old World architectural styles gained popularity in the U.S. The first of these movements was inspired by the temples of ancient Greece.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Read the first paragraph and the section called "All Roads Lead to...Greece."
∞ Article Link: The Old is New Again
2. Read about Farmer's Greek Revival homes (from To Grandfather's House We Go).
∞ PDF Link: Architecture in the 1800s

→ SKETCH

Look at the Greek Revival house and sketch any details you would like into your notebook.

∞ Image Link: Greek Revival House

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 10 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 44

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.62-74 "Perhaps the imminent" - "San Francisco sunshine."

→ VIEW

This part of the webinar talks about the kinds of ships the Chinese sailed on.

∞ Video Link: Stanford University Research (11:40-14:48)

★ TEACHER NOTE

Note the use of curse words on p.74. One in today's reading, and one in the next reading.

WEEK 11 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 45

Architecture

Materials: Notebook

→ INTRO

Today, we will look at another architectural style influenced by the Old World—Gothic Revival. These homes in the 1800s were romantic adaptations of medieval architecture. Delicate wooden ornaments and other decorative details suggested the architecture of medieval England. These homes did not try to replicate authentic Gothic styles—no flying buttresses were needed to hold up the Gothic Revival homes found throughout America. Instead, they became the elegant farm homes of a growing America. Here are some of the characteristics:

- Pointed windows with decorative tracery
- Grouped chimneys
- Pinnacles (spires or peaks)
- Leaded glass
- Quatrefoil and clover-shaped windows
- Oriel windows- bay window that projects from an upper floor and is supported by a bracket
- Asymmetrical floor plan
- Steeply pitched roofs

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read Gothic Revival Rectory House on the second page of the PDF. (from To Grandfather's House We Go)

∞ PDF Link: Architecture in the 1800s

→ VIEW

Look at these examples of Gothic Revival found in the US.

1. ∞ Image Link: St. Francisville Inn (Baton Rouge, LA)
2. ∞ Image Link: The Lake-Peterson House (Rockford, IL)
3. ∞ Image Link: Gothic Revival Rectory (Old Saybrook, CT)

→ SKETCH

Look at the Gothic Revival houses and sketch any details you would like into your notebook.

★ TEACHER NOTE

There are two curse words on p.74. You may choose to skip the last paragraphs on p.82, since it refers to a woman's cycle.

WEEK 11 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 46

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ INTRO

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

By 1861, an engineer named Theodore Judah had enlisted a group of investors in Sacramento to form the Central Pacific Railroad Company. He then headed to Washington, D.C., where he was able to convince congressional leaders, as well as President Lincoln, who signed the Pacific Railroad Act into law the following year. The Central Pacific Railroad Company would start building in Sacramento and continue east across the Sierra Nevada, while a second company, the Union Pacific Railroad, would build westward from the Missouri River, near the Iowa-Nebraska border.

The two lines of track would meet in the middle (the bill did not designate an exact location), and each company would receive 6,400 acres of land (later doubled to 12,800) and \$48,000 in government bonds for every mile of track built. From the beginning, then, the building of the transcontinental railroad was set up in terms of a competition between the two companies. (from history.com)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.74-81 "Descending the gangplank" - "they had come." (Skipping p.81-82 for the sake of time and content.)
2. p.83-86 "Payday was the" - "in her fist."

WEEK 12 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 47

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Abraham Lincoln and Frederick Douglass: The Story Behind an American Friendship

WEEK 12 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 48

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 49

Meeting Louis Hughes

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ INTRO

In 1832, a baby boy was born around Charlottesville, Virginia. His name would be Louis Hughes, and he was the son of a black mother and a white father. Louis would marry, have children, and live through the events of the Civil War. In his old age, he would write a memoir, sharing his life story.

In *A Year in the South*, author and Civil War historian Stephen Ash uses Louis Hughes' memoir and other additional primary sources to detail one of the most eventful years in the history of the United States: 1865. This is the year that the Civil War would come to an end. But what did the victory of the Civil War mean for the men and women still enslaved in the South? When did freedom come? These are just a few of the questions Stephen Ash will answer in his book.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.19-28

- What surprised you in the reading?

• IMPORTANT DATES

Civil War ends on April 9th, 1865
Lincoln is assassinated on April 14th, 1865

WEEK 1 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 50

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ INTRO

What kind of dangers do you think the railroad workers faced during the building of the transcontinental railroad?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.86-97 "Lin Fan stood" - "a lazy cook."

★ TEACHER NOTE

Note the curse word on p.96.

WEEK 2 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 51

Meeting Cornelia McDonald

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ INTRO

In the prologue of *A Year in the South*, Stephen Ash introduces his audience to Cornelia McDonald. He writes, "When 1865 began, Cornelia McDonald was forty-two years old and living in a rented house in Lexington, Virginia, with her seven children. She was a widow and a war refugee. The death of her husband, a Confederate army officer, and the loss of her home had brought her to the verge of poverty and despair."

Cornelia McDonald was born in Virginia. She was born in 1822 to a well-off family. Her family had owned slaves, and she had grown up never needing to work with her hands. How does the victory of the Union in 1865 impact this young mother and widow? Author and Civil War historian Stephen Ash will use many different primary sources to piece together this young woman's story.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.29-37 stop at "all year round."

- What is something in Cornelia's story that you didn't expect to read?

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 2 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 52

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ NOTE

We are skipping Ch.10 for the sake of time.

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ INTRO

In Ch.10, Ling Fan starts her new job of cooking food for the crew. She assists Tan Din, and most of the people complain about the bad food.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.105-116 "For the next" - "mountain work camps."

→ VIEW

∞ Video: Stanford University Research

This section shows pictures of the tents where the workers slept. (34:48-36:55)

★ TEACHER NOTE

Note the curse word on p.111.

WEEK 3 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 53

Meeting Cornelia McDonald Continued...

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ RECAP

Think back to where you left off?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.37-45 start at "when an opportunity" - end of chapter

- What stood out to you in the reading?

WEEK 3 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 54

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.117-127 "Storm's coming" - "that bonus money."

★ TEACHER NOTE

You may want to discuss opium, which is mentioned in this section.

WEEK 4 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 55

Cornelia McDonald In the Spring

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ RECAP

Think back to where you left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.97-107

- War impacts everyone, but it does so in many different ways. What are some of the impacts on Cornelia, her family, and her town that you see in the reading?

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 4 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 56

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.128-143 "Now more than" - "to find out."

WEEK 5 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 57

Louis Hughes in the Spring

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ INTRO

Like many enslaved women and men, Louis Hughes had dreams of being free. He would run away a couple of times, and every time he received a punishment. His story highlights the evil that we must face as those who study history. Humans are capable of great evil towards each other. Sin is a part of the human experience, and we can trace it to every place and every time.

In his book, *Why Study History*, John Fea writes, "Indeed, anyone who studies the past realizes that there are no heroes in history. While people may perform heroic acts, all humans are tainted by sin and are susceptible to acting in ways that preference themselves over others and God. Historians understand, perhaps better than most, the reality of the pain, suffering, injustice, anger, and vice brought on by sin. In other words, they understand the tragic dimensions of life."

History reminds us of the inherent weakness in the human condition and the very real possibility that our fellow human beings are capable of horrendous things. This should humble us, for "there, but for the grace of God, go I." One day, there will be a new heaven and new earth where there will be no more death or mourning or crying or pain.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.109-118 stop at "and poultry alike."

- How does Louis Hughes' story tell you more about what's going on in his community?

• STUDENT TIP

Be sure to add some people, events, and drawings of artifacts to your book of centuries.

WEEK 5 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 58

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.143-156 "There were three" - "the base camp."

→ VIEW

∞ Video: Stanford University Research

A historian shows photographs of the work it took to lay tracks across mountains. (28:05-30:17)

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 6 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 59

Louis Hughes in the Spring

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ RECAP

Think back to where you left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.122-124 start at "With the war" - end of chapter

- What surprised you about Louis Hughes' story?

WEEK 6 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 60

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ NOTE

We are skipping Ch.16 for the sake of time.

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.172-174 "Snow!" - "into the mountain!"

p.175-187 "As it turned out" - "earnings to me."

→ VIEW

∞ Video: Stanford University Research

A historian shows photos of the tunnels that had to be created by the workers. (30:19-32:30)

WEEK 7 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 61

Louis Hughes in Summer

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ INTRO

With the surrender of General Lee to Ulysses Grant on April 9th, 1865, and the Emancipation Proclamation, enslaved men and women waited for their freedom to come, as their enslavers did not seem keen on letting them go free without influence from the soldiers.

In June of 1865, Louis Hughes and his wife and children were still waiting for their freedom to come. They waited and waited for their freedom. How long did they have to wait? How long until they could leave the plantation and become free men and women?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.127-135 stop at "join the escape"

- What do you think it was like for people like Louis Hughes to have to wait for their freedom?

WEEK 7 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 62

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ INTRO

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

We are skipping a couple of pages. As you recall, Wong Wei found out that Ling Fan was a girl. He then stabbed her with a knife. It was a shallow wound, but she was in pain. That is where we pick up the story.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.189-205 "Ling Fang hauled" - "following her too."

WEEK 8 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 63

Louis Hughes in Summer

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ RECAP

Think back to where you left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.135-142 start at "they halted at" - end of chapter

WEEK 8 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 64

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.206-214 "Rumors rippled through" - "air, alive and safe."

WEEK 9 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 65

Cornelia McDonald in Summer

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ INTRO

Cornelia McDonald was impoverished. Her kids were too busy working to go to school, and even if she could make things work, she still couldn't afford to send them to school. The Civil War had left her a widow and a single mother, and now she found herself barely able to afford to eat and send her kids to school. How did this mother survive summer? How would she stay standing with everything against her? She was facing the uncertainty of life just as much as anyone else.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.157-166 stop at "demanded their surrender."

WEEK 9 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 66

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ INTRO

We skipped a couple of pages for the sake of time in the last chapter and the beginning of this one. After payday, Wong Wei snuck up on Ling Fan and put a knife to her throat and made her give him her hard-earned money. She knew that as long as Wong Wei had the power to expose her secret, she would be at his mercy. "The only way to free herself was to destroy the web and crush the spider."

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.218-226 "Late winter turned" - "her next job."
p.230-239 "A smoky haze" - "what I've started."

WEEK 10 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 67

Cornelia McDonald in Summer and Fall

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ RECAP

Think back to where you left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.166-169 start at "although they were" - end of chapter
p.197-204 stop at "when Angus died."

- How did Cornelia's circumstances change in this reading?

WEEK 10 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 68

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.240-251

- Are you surprised that O'Brien was behind the "accidents"?

★ TEACHER NOTE

There are two curse words in this reading—p.247 & 250.

WEEK 11 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 69

Cornelia McDonald and Louis Hughes in Fall

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ INTRO

1865 was a year marked by many uncertainties. As men and women were freed from the bondage of slavery, they would need to find homes, jobs, and safe havens where they could relish their freedom. And households that had built their wealth on the backs of slaves would need to transition quickly to be able to sustain themselves. The year 1865 would be one of the most tumultuous years in the history of the United States, but the fight for freedom didn't end with the Emancipation Proclamation or the winning of the Civil War. The rest of the 1800s would be filled with a struggle for equality that was just beginning.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.204-217 start at "She sat down" - end of chapter

- Compare Cornelia McDonald's fall to Louis Hughes' fall.

WEEK 11 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 70

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.25-27 p.252-272

- Do you think there is any way Ling Fan can begin to describe her

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3	
experience in America to her family? • What are some lessons do you think she may have learned from her time working on the railroad?	
WEEK 12 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 71 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: A Year in the South: 1865	
WEEK 12 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 72 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Gold Mountain	

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

Examination

Term 1

- Describe one part of Sacajawea's journey that stood out to you.
- Tell what you know about the different groups of people and what their motivations were for moving west.

Term 2

- Why do you think Lincoln and Douglass had a unique bond, and how did they both fight against slavery?
- Tell about how women fought for equal rights. OR Tell what life was like in the cities and some of the issues that needed to be addressed with working and living conditions.

Term 3

- You read about Louis Hughes' and Cornelia McDonald's lives in the year 1865, after the Civil War ended. Choose one of these people and summarize their lives. What were the big milestones they faced?
- Tell about the story of Ling Fan and what you learned about the Chinese workers who worked on the transcontinental railroad.